

US-Iran escalation odds rise as Trump eyes post-midterm bombing

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【要点】

- ・米国とイランの大規模な軍事エスカレーション確率が25%から35%に上昇しており、中東地域での合意達成の可能性は低下している。
- ・米国はイラン中東部での限定的な軍事作戦を検討しており、イランのミサイル備蓄と核施設への大規模爆撃キャンペーンはイランの激しい報復と油価格上昇を招く可能性がある。
- ・イランは海運への攻撃を継続し、米国は中間選挙後にエスカレーション選択肢を検討する一方で、現在の膠着状態（55%の確率）が年末までの最も可能性の高いシナリオである。
- ・「ゾンビUSMCA」シナリオ（新しい三国間協定なし）がトランプ政権期間を通じて継続する可能性が80%であり、米国とメキシコは年末までに自動車と鉄鋼の関税救済を含む限定的な通商協定を締結する見通しである。
- ・米国とカナダの2026年の通商協定は政治的条件により実現困難（確率40%）だが、自動車製造業は米国の関税措置によるカナダとメキシコ間の相違リスクが最も高い。

【メール原文】

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"Zombie USMCA" will endure through Trump's term

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Republicans would move quickly to confirm a replacement for Alito or Thomas

US-Iran escalation odds rise as Trump eyes post-midterm bombing. Both Iran and the US are preparing for a significant escalation (35% odds, up from 25%) given the lack of progress towards a deal (10% odds, down from 15%), and the US has deployed additional offensive and defensive assets to the region.

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A protracted standoff remains the most likely scenario (55% odds, down from 60%) through the rest of the year, due to the risks both sides face in significantly escalating.

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Iran will maintain pressure on the US with more aggressive strikes on shipping, while the US will consider escalation options after the midterm elections—if regional output falls due to Iranian attacks, the case for US escalation will strengthen.

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If the US resumes military operations it may focus on Iranian capabilities in the Gulf, hitting targets along the Iranian coast to further degrade its ability to harass shipping. A major bombing campaign targeting Iran's missile stockpiles and nuclear sites, which was considered in the late summer, would trigger intense retaliation and move oil prices above their current \$90-110 per barrel range.

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For more, please see Escalation risk ticks up as Trump ponders bombing after midterms , 7 October 2026.

"Zombie USMCA" will endure through Trump's term. A "Zombie USMCA" scenario, with no new trilateral agreement and continued exemptions under the United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) from US Section 301 tariffs, is likely to persist through the rest of Trump's term (80% odds).

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The US and Mexico are likely to conclude a limited trade deal that would provide relief from US sectoral tariffs on autos and steel by year's end (65% odds); however, a US-Canada agreement in 2026 remains unlikely (40% odds), given the political conditions in both countries, although a major escalation would be surprising.

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Auto manufacturing, the most integrated sector in North America, faces the highest risk of US tariff divergence between Canada and Mexico in our basecase; elsewhere, North American trade integration will likely continue broadly unchanged, with Ottawa and Mexico City able to rely on the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP) as a bilateral free trade backstop.

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For more, please see Zombie USMCA will endure through Trump's term , 7 October 2026.

Republicans would move quickly to confirm a replacement for Alito or Thomas. With Democrats now likely to win the Senate (60% odds), it will be a steep uphill battle—verging on outright impossibility—for Republicans to confirm replacements for any Supreme Court justices, should a vacancy open in 2027 or 2028.

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Justices Samuel Alito and Clarence Thomas, anchors of the court's conservative wing, are the most likely vacancies to open; both are in their mid-to-late 70s and have had health issues in the past.

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While both appear committed to staying on the court through the next two years, if either did decide to retire after a Democratic victory in November, Republicans could probably jam through a confirmation of a replacement in the lame duck session, before Democrats take up the gavel in early January.

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Under Majority Leader John Thune (R-SD), the Senate has pushed the procedural envelope; it moved remarkably quickly on a reconciliation bill earlier this year and last year expedited the process for confirming batches of nominees in a single vote. Much like when Amy Coney Barrett was confirmed in just 30 days ahead of the 2020 election, we think a similar ethos would prevail if any Supreme Court vacancies open after the midterms; the fact that this could be Republicans' last chance to confirm any replacements until 2033 (pending the result of the 2028 election) would likely be enough to overcome any procedural concerns in the conference.

Quote of the Day

"Here in Michigan, we know that Canada is not our enemy. We need to end this tariff war now." – Republicans' Michigan Senate candidate, Mike Rogers, in an ad airing this week in the race. With Rogers running behind Democrat Abdul El-Sayed, his best chances of victory are to separate himself from Trump's most unpopular policies, especially a trade war with Canada that has an outsized impact in the border state. But while this strategy could boost Rogers on the margins, the national environment—driven by Trump's unpopularity—is probably too negative for Republicans for him to flip the Democratic-held seat.

On the Radar

12-18 October: IMF and World Bank Annual Meetings

30-31 October: G20 Foreign Ministers' meeting

3 November: National midterm elections

9 November: Congress returns from recess

18-19 November: APEC leaders meeting in China

11 December: Government funding runs out

14-15 December: G20 summit in Florida

10 January: US-China tariff truce expires

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